

# History of Globalisation: 19th-21th centuries.

Jérôme Sgard, SciencesPo/ CERI  
[jerome.sgard@sciencespo.fr](mailto:jerome.sgard@sciencespo.fr)

Le Havre, room B3  
Wednesday, 5:40 – 7:40 pm

This 24 hours course proposes to students a comparative study of the two main, modern global eras, covering broadly the 1850-1914 years and post-1990 ones. The lectures will rest first on international political history (hence imperialism, international law, the Concert of Nations, the move to multilateralism, etc); then, on international economic history (trade, finance, migrations). The main thread of this exploration, however, will be ‘global governance’, a ubiquitous term today, though one that, remarkably, did not have a clear equivalent pre-1914. Statesmen, diplomats and academics typically had little knowledge of how global markets worked. Both the politics and the language of globalization are very different between these two periods. And of course, the dimension of conflicts, contestation and fragmentation will be a full part of the course. Globalization has never been a steady state.

Depending upon the number of students, I shall mix readings & class discussions with more classic, structured teaching. A developed syllabus with a substantial list of references will be prepared once the principle of this class is agreed upon. Control will be based, *prima facie*, on a midterm essay (eg 70% of total mark) and in-class, final exam (30%).

I would certainly prefer that this course takes place in the first half of the coming academic year (hence fall 2025). Wednesday morning would be a perfect fit in my usual weekly agenda.

Control:

- a 5000 words essay, reference excluded, footnotes included (70% of total mark). French and English language possible. There is no required referencing style, though you should be consistent.

**Submission date: Tuesday 11 november, 12pm (midnight)**

See also the separate note: “Writing a Fine Mid-Term Essay: a Few Tips”.

- a final oral exam (30%) on the essay and on the course more generally; participation will also be taken into account.

Yet, as regard essay-writing and evaluation, things have changed with the irruption of Chatgpt and other Artificial Intelligence devices. Like probably all other universities in the world SciencesPo has worked a lot on this, with only partial conclusions so far. The key point however is that our job is to help and learn students thinking by themselves, hence having a sound,

critical approach of issues and evidences so that they reach conclusions and decisions on their own, that are not only right, but also well-founded and articulated. And at this point, I'll keep insisting, raising a precise, insightful, thorough-going question is critical (read here the note on 'How to Write A Fine Essay'). The question you raise should be like a scalpel: shift a little bit the view-angle, or the terms of your question, and your whole argument may take very different, hence more or less promising directions. And at this point, AI is of no help at all. It remains in practice an information-treatment instrument, that may possibly help you backing up elements of your argument empirically; but it will give you neither a powerful, promising research question, nor a sharp, analytical argument that will take you, throughout your essay, from question to answer. AI-based Essays typically float around a few themes, vaguely assembling bits of evidence before reaching a non-controversial, low added-value, conclusion. AI is shallow intelligence.

> Still, regarding your essays: I will keep the discretionary right to invite any student to come and discuss his/ her essay after submission so as to check how well he/she is in control of the evidences and underlying concepts. The eventual mark will be based on both the essay and this oral examination.

#### Practicalities.

The Syllabus provides for each lecture the references to 1 or 2 articles, or book chapters, that students will read in advance. They will be uploaded on our joint Moodle web-page.

Sometimes, I may add another text or two over time, though the rule is clear: once a text is posted there, you are welcome to read it. This Syllabus also includes complementary, quality references, if a given topic is of special interest to you.

The Powerpoint presentations will be posted one day or two before each lecture.

**Office hours.** Students are welcome to come their essay, or any problem with the course during my office hours, though they should first ask for a zoom-appointment. As a rule, I try to find a time-slot as soon as possible.

# Lectures & Readings

## **Lecture 1: Why Europe and not ‘the Rest’ ?**

\* Wong, Bin R. 1997. *China Transformed*. Cornell University Press. [chapter 1]

- Allen, R. 2011. Why the industrial revolution was British: Commerce, induced invention, and the scientific revolution. *The Economic History Review*, 64(2), 357-384.
- Broadberry, S., Guan, H., & Li, D. 2018. China, Europe, and the Great Divergence: A Study in Historical National Accounting, 980–1850. *The Journal of Economic History*, 78(4), 955-1000.
- Kuran, Timur. *The Long Divergence. How Islamic Law Held back the Middle East*. Princeton: Princeton University Press, 405 p.
- Kuran, Timur. 2004. Why the Middle East Is Economically Underdeveloped: Historical Mechanisms of Institutional Stagnation. *The Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 18 (3), pp. 71-90
- Li, B., & Van Zanden, J. 2012. Before the Great Divergence? Comparing the Yangzi Delta and the Netherlands at the Beginning of the Nineteenth Century. *The Journal of Economic History*, 72(4), 956-989.
- Pomeranz, Kenneth, 2010. *The Great Divergence, China, Europe and the Making of the Modern World Economy*. Princeton University Press, 371 p. [édition française, Albin Michel, 2010].
- Tilly, Charles. 1992. *Coercion, Capital, and European States, AD 990-1992*. Cambridge Mass: Blackwell. 271 p.

## **Lecture 2: The basic economics of trade, tariffs, and income: pre-1914 vs post-1945**

- \* Scott C. James and David A. Lake. 1989. The Second Face of Hegemony: Britain's Repeal of the Corn Laws and the American Walker Tariff of 1846. *International Organization*. 43 1), pp. 1-29.
- Krugman, P. 1993. What Do Undergrads Need to Know About Trade? *The American Economic Review*, 83(2).
- Krugman, Paul. 1999. The Role of Geography in Development. *International Regional Science Review*. 22 (2), pp. 143-161.
- Bannerman G. 2014. The Free Trade Idea. In: *Oxford Handbook on the Political Economy of International Trade*. OUP, pp. 37-56
- Gowa, Joanne. 2014. Explaining the GATT/WTO: origins and effects. *Oxford Handbook on the Political Economy of International Trade*. OUP, pp. 19-36.
- Irwin, D. 2020. Trade Policy in American Economic History. *Annual Review of Economics*. 12, pp.
- O’ Rourke, Kevin and Williamson, Jeffrey. 2002. After Columbus: Explaining Europe’s Overseas Trade Boom, 1500-1800. *The Journal of Economic History*. 62 2), 417-455.

### **Lecture 3: Capital movements, the Gold standard and class struggles: Keynes**

- \* Flandreau, Marc and Juan Flores. 2012. The Peaceful Conspiracy: Bond Markets and International Relations During the Pax Britannica. *International Organization*, 66 (2), pp. 211-241.

Eichengreen B. 2019. Financial History, Historical Analysis, and the New History of Finance Capital. *Capitalism: A Journal of History and Economics*, 1(1), pp. 20-58. Cite this article

Eichengreen, B., Flandreau, M. 2012. The Federal Reserve, the Bank of England, and the Rise of the Dollar as an International Currency, 1914–1939. *Open Economic Review*. 23, 57–87.

Eichengreen, B. Two Views of the International Monetary System. *Intereconomics* 54, 233–236 (2019).

Donald N. McCloskey, J. Richard Zecher. 1981. How the Gold Standard Worked, 1880–1913. *Enterprise and Trade in Victorian Britain*.

Herger, N. 2019. A Brief History of Central Banks. In: *Understanding Central Banks*. Springer, Cham.

Ruggie, John G. 1982. International Regimes, Transactions, and Change: Embedded Liberalism in the Postwar Economic Order. *International Organization*. 36 (2), pp. 379-415

### **Lecture 4: Migration, labor markets and inequalities**

[to be completed]

### **Lecture 5: Colonization: the case of India**

- \* Washbrook, David. 1993. Economic Depression and the Making of ‘Traditional’ Society in Colonial India, 1820-1855. *Transactions of the Royal Historical Society*. 237-63.
- Darwin, John. 2012. *Unfinished Empire, The Global Expansion of Britain*. London: Penguin Book, 478 p. [chapter 6, for instance]
- Acemoglu Daren, et al. 2001. The Colonial Origins of Comparative Development: An Empirical Investigation. *American Economic Review*. December, pp. 1369-1401.
- Raman, A. 2022. Indian cotton textiles and British industrialization. *The Economic History Review*. 75 (2), pp. 447-74.
- Roy, T. Indigo and law in colonial India. *The Economic History Review*. 64 (1), pp. 60-75.
- Stern, PH J. 2011. *The Company-state. Corporate Sovereignty and the Early Modern Foundation of the British Empire in India*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Washbrook, D. 2007. India in the early modern world economy: Modes of production, reproduction and exchange. *Journal of Global History*, 2(1), 87-111.

## **Lecture 6: Extractive colonies, the 'Natural resource curse'**

\* Acemoglu D. Francisco A. Gallego and James A. Robinson. 2014. Institutions, Human Capital, and Development. *Annual Review of Economics*. Vol. 6, pp. 875-912

Canen, Nathan, and Leonard Wantchekon. 2022. Political Distortions, State Capture, and Economic Development in Africa. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 36 (1): 101-24.

Dell M. and BA Olken. 2020/ The Development Effects of the Extractive Colonial Economy: The Dutch Cultivation System in Java. *The Review of Economic Studies*, 87 (1), pp. 164–203.

Sala-i-Martin Xavier, Arvind Subramanian. 2013, Addressing the Natural Resource Curse: An Illustration from Nigeria. *Journal of African Economies*, 22 (4), pp. 570–615.

Soares de Oliveira, R. 2007. Business success, Angola-Style. *Journal of Modern African Studies*. 45 (4), pp. 595-619.

Sonno, Tommaso. 2025. Globalization and Conflicts: the Good, the Bad, and the Ugly of Corporations in Africa. *The Economic Journal*, 135, n° 668, pp. 1108–1140,

## **Lecture 7: Informal empires, extra-territoriality and international law**

\* Benton L, Clulow A. 2015. Legal encounters and the origins of global law. In: Bentley JH, Subrahmanyam S, Wiesner-Hanks ME, eds. *The Cambridge World History, vol 4*. Cambridge University Press; pp. 80-100.

Cogneau, Denis and Alexander Moradi. 2014. Borders That Divide: Education and Religion in Ghana and Togo Since Colonial Times. *Journal of Economic History*, 74(3): 694-729.

Osafo-Kwaako, Ph. and J. Robinson. 2013. Political Centralization in Pre-Colonial Africa. *Journal of Comparative Economics*, 41(1), 534-564.

Benton, L and L Ford. 2016. *Rage for Order, The British Empire and the Origins of International Law, 1800-1850*. Harvard UP, 282 pages.

Koskenniemi, Martti. 2005. Nationalism, Universalism, Empire : International Law in 1871 and 1919. Columbia Department of History, April. 46 pages.

Gallagher, John, and Ronald Robinson. 1953. The Imperialism of Free Trade. *The Economic History Review*. 2d series, 6 1), pp. 1-15

## **Lecture 8: Catching up with the West: authoritarian modernization (Germany, Japan)**

\* Gershenkron, A. 1962. *Economic Backwardness in Historical Perspective*. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press.

Braun, S. and R. Franke. 2022. Railways, Growth and Industrialization in a Developing German Economy, 1829-1910. *Journal of Economic History*, 82 (4), pp. 1183-1221.

Hennock E. P. 2007. *The Origin of the Welfare State in England and Germany, 1850–1914: Social Policies Compared*.

James, Harold. 2012. *Krupp: A History of the Legendary German Firm*. Princeton: Princeton U.P.

Perkins, JA. 1981. The Agricultural Revolution in Germany 1850–1914. *Journal of European Economic History*, 10 (1), pp 71-119.

- Tilly, Richard. 1989. German Industrialization and Gershenkronian Backwardness. *Rivista di Storia Economica*. Nova seria, 6 (2), junio. pp 139-164
- Tilly, Richard. 1994. On the Development of German Big Banks as Universal Banks in the 19<sup>th</sup> and 20<sup>th</sup> Centuries. Engine of Growth or Power Block ? *German Yearbook on Business History*, 1993. pp. 109-130
- Timmer M. P. 2016. The Yankees of Europe? A New View on Technology and Productivity in German Manufacturing in the Early Twentieth Century. *The Journal of Economic History*. 76 (3), pp. 874-908.
- Torp C. 2010. The "Coalition of 'Rye and Iron'" under the Pressure of Globalization: A Reinterpretation of Germany's Political Economy before 1914. *Central European History*, 401-27.

***On a similar theme, you may read :***

- Allen, R. 2014. American Exceptionalism as a Problem in Global History. *The Journal of Economic History*, 74(2), 309-350.
- Henricksen, I., Lampe, M., & Sharp, P. 2012. The strange birth of liberal Denmark: Danish trade protection and the growth of the dairy industry since the mid-nineteenth century. *The Economic History Review*, 65(2), 770-788.
- Meissner, C., & Tang, J. 2018. Upstart Industrialization and Exports: Evidence from Japan, 1880–1910. *The Journal of Economic History*, 78(4), 1068-1102.
- Pamuk, Ş, & Williamson, J. 2011. Ottoman de-industrialization, 1800–1913: Assessing the magnitude, impact, and response. *The Economic History Review*, 64(S1), 159-184.
- Tang, J. 2011. Technological leadership and late development: Evidence from Meiji Japan, 1868–1912. *The Economic History Review*, 64(S1), 99-116.
- Tang, J. 2014. Railroad Expansion and Industrialization: Evidence from Meiji Japan. *The Journal of Economic History*, 74(3), 863-886.

**Lecture 9: The regulatory state in the West and the crisis of classic liberalism**

- \* Schmitter, Ph. 1974. Still the Century of Corporatism? *The Review of Politics*. 36 (1), pp. 85-131.

- Sawyer, Laura Phillips. 2018. *American Fair Trade. Proprietary Capitalism, Corporatism, and the 'New Competition', 1890-1940*. Cambridge: Cambridge UP. 376p.
- Francis, Daniel. 2025. The 2023 Merger Guidelines and the Arc of Antitrust History. *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 39 (1): 3–28.
- Majone G. 1994. The rise of the regulatory state in Europe. *West European Politics*, 17:3, 77-101

**Lecture 10: From empire to multilateralism: two models of international hegemony**

- \* Clavin, Patricia and Jensèn-Wilhelm Wessels. 2005. Transnationalism and the League of Nations: Understanding the Work of Its Economic and Financial Organisation. *Contemporary European History*. 14 (4), pp. 465-92.
- Eichengreen, B. 1992. *Golden Fetters, The Gold Exchange Standard and the Great Depression, 1919-1939*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 447p.
- James, H. 2001. *The End of Globalization*. Harvard: Harvard University Press.

- Marcus, N. 2019. *Austrian Reconstruction and the Collapse of Global Finance*. Harvard University Press, 546 pages.
- Rosenberg, E. S 1999. *Financial Missionaries to the World, the Politics and Culture of Dollar Diplomacy, 1900-1930*. Cambridge (Mass.): Harvard University Press, 334p..
- Sgard, J. 2023. Inventing IMF Conditionality, Exploring its Politics (1946-1958). Chapter 1 of: *The Debt Crisis of the 1980s, Law and Political Economy*. Forthcoming, fall 2023.
- Tooze, A. 2014. *The Deluge: The Great War, America and the Remaking of the Global Order, 1916-1931*. New York: Viking Press. 672 pages.

## **Lecture 11: The invention of development, import-substitution and the ‘Dependencia’**

- \* Ekbladh D. 2010. Meeting the Challenge from Totalitarianism: The Tennessee Valley Authority as a Global Model for Liberal Development, 1933–1945. *The International History Review*. 32 (1), pp. 47-67.
- Cardoso, F. H. 1972-73. Industrialization, Dependency and Power in Latin America. *Studies Berkeley Journal of Sociology*. 17, pp. 79-95.
- Dosman, E. 2008. *The Life and Time of Raul Prebisch, 1901-1986*. McGill-Queen’s UP, 599 p.
- Helleiner, Eric. 2014. *Forgotten Foundations of Bretton Woods. International Development and the Making of the Postwar Order*. Ithaca: Cornell UP, 304 p.
- Krugman, Paul. The Fall and Rise of Development Economics.  
<http://web.mit.edu/krugman/www/dishpan.html>
- Love, Joseph L. 1980. Raul Prebisch and the Origins of the Doctrine of Unequal Exchange. *Latin American Research Review*. 15 (3), pp. 45-72.
- Paolera G. della., Xavier H. Duran Amorochio, Aldo Musacchio. 2018. The Industrialization of South America Revisited: Evidence from Argentina, Brazil, Chile and Colombia, 1890-2010. NBER Working Paper No. 24345, February 2018.

## **Lecture 12: Globalization, the challenge to the West, and Trump**

- \* Keohane RO, and Joseph S. Nye, Jr. 2000. Globalization: What's New? What's Not? (And So What?). *Foreign Policy*, 118, pp. 104-119
- \* Goldberg, Pinelopi K., and Tristan Reed. 2023. Is the Global Economy Deglobalizing? And If So, Why? And What Is Next? *Brookings Papers on Economic Activity* 54 (1): 347–423.
- Morgan, T. C, C Syropoulos, Y. Yotov. 2023 Economic Sanctions: Evolution, Consequences, and Challenges. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*. 37 (1), pp. 3-30.
- Mulder, Nicholas. 2022. *The Economic Weapon. The Rise of Sanctions as a Tool of Modern War*. New Heaven: Yale University Press. 432 p. [chapter 1].
- Hoekman, B and Petros C Mavroidis. 2020. To AB or Not to AB? Dispute Settlement in WTO Reform. *Journal of International Economic Law*, 23 (3), pp 1–20.
- Duffie, Darrell. 2025. "How US Treasuries Can Remain the World's Safe Haven." *Journal of Economic Perspectives*. 39 (2): 195–214.